CROSS-BORDER NOTES

A bank compliance team in Amman cut off my climate data pitch halfway through.

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They did not want the impact story. They wanted to know if this would get them closer to their green lending quota before the deadline.

Sustainability teams write the narrative. They do not sign the purchase order.

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Compliance teams own the quota. Missing it triggers a regulatory penalty, not a bad headline.

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Local banks buy climate data because the cost of non-compliance is priced and dated. Goodwill is not.

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Underwriting frontier market climate exposure? Read the mandate, not the ESG deck. Who gets penalized, and by when?

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